

car is a reward, a privilege for which I continue to pay dearly. But I don't lie to myself. It is not, and never will be, an investment.

Strategic investments, critical partnerships, and crucial financial timing led to the exponential growth of my wealth. But ultimately, it's this little-known and little-followed piece of advice that is the real key to growing wealth: Grow your money, not your lifestyle. Get into the habit early, kids, and maybe you'll earn yourself a Porsche one day, too. Maybe even before you lose your hair.

Money Mistake: You're Unsure Who Should Pay for What When Dating

THE FIX: TALK MONEY, THE SOONER THE BETTER

When should money begin to factor into a relationship? At what stage should you start to talk about money? Right from the get-go: the first date. Anytime there is a bill before you, or a movie ticket to pay for, is an opportunity to talk about money.

I have a son and a daughter. When I'm speaking to them together, I tell them this: Men should pay for the first date. It demonstrates that the guy is employed, is probably responsible, and can be relied upon to do the right thing. If Savannah dates a guy who proposes to split the bill on the first date, or lets her pay if she politely offers, I'm going to think he's a bozo and not worth her time, even if *she* asked *him* out. And I tell Trevor, "If you can't pay for a first date, you shouldn't be dating. You should be thinking about how to make more money."

However, when I speak to my kids separately, I give them conflicting advice, and in that overlap I hope they'll find their own way to navigate the financial aspects of dating. Here's what I mean. I tell Trevor that he should always pay when dating—I am an old-fashioned guy. Remember, I was raised by an elegant Mediterranean man who would never let my mother pay for a thing. On the flip side, I tell Savannah that, after the first date, she should offer to pay. In the overlap created by a man who assumes he should pay and a woman who offers, a couple will eventually map out their own financial